



Reparations and global development

Reparations Payments Database (RPD) - Codebook (Version 1, April 2026)

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The database can be found at: <https://www.reparationsresearch.eu/database>

Data and Citation:

The Reparations Payments Database (RPD) and its accompanying codebook can be downloaded at:
<https://www.reparationsresearch.eu/database>

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Declaration of AI usage:

The authors used AI tools (ChatGPT) to support the execution and troubleshooting of Python codes used for data cleaning, data collection, and the population of selected categories defined in this codebook. All AI-assisted outputs were independently checked and validated by the authors.

Reparations Payments Database (RPD): Codebook and data definitions

Category	Variable name	Values	Description
ID & Name	ID*	Unique value [Payor ISO code]-[Recipient ISO code]-[Year of agreement]-[Sequential number]	A unique identifier assigned to each reparation case in the RPD. It follows the format [Payor country ISO code]-[Recipient country ISO code]-[Year of agreement]-[Sequential number]. The sequential number distinguishes multiple cases between the same payor and recipient in the same year. The ID ensures consistent referencing, easy retrieval, and accurate citation.
	Program name	Unique value [Text]	A descriptive title for each entry. It is taken from the reparations program, law, court case, or agreement where available, or assigned by the REPAIR team to enable quick identification and reference.
Actors involved	Payor	Unique value [Text]	The entity formally responsible for providing reparations payments, i.e., the actor that agreed, pledged, or was ordered to make the payments, though not necessarily the ultimate source of the funds.
	Payor type	Corporation Country or government Educational institution Individual(s) International or multilateral organization Non-governmental organization Religious institution Multiple Other	The classification of the entity responsible for providing reparations payments.
	Payor private or public	Private Public Both	Indicates whether the entity responsible for providing the reparations payment is a public actor (state or government-affiliated) or a private actor (non-state).
	Payor country or economy	Unique value [Country or economy]	The country or economy held responsible for providing reparations, either directly or as the home/origin of the payor entity. The list of countries and economies is based on the World Bank classification (see: https://data.worldbank.org/country).
	Payor country or economy (ISO)*	Unique value [ISO code]	The standardized three-letter ISO 3166-1 alpha-3 code representing the country or economy that provided the reparations payment, as defined by the International Organization for Standardization (see: https://www.iso.org/iso-3166-country-codes.html). If no ISO code is available or applicable, "XXX" is used instead.

*The data in this category were populated either fully or partially through Python automation, with ChatGPT assisting in scripting and troubleshooting.



Payor region*	East Asia and Pacific Europe and Central Asia Latin America and the Caribbean Middle East and North Africa North America South Asia Sub-Saharan Africa Not applicable	The geographic region of the payor, classified according to the World Bank's regional categories (see: https://data.worldbank.org/country).
Payor income level*	Low income Lower middle income Upper middle income High income Not applicable	The payor's income level is based on the World Bank's 2024 classification (see: https://data.worldbank.org/country and https://ourworldindata.org/grapher/world-bank-income-groups).
Recipient(s)	<i>Unique value [Text]</i>	The individual, group, or institution formally designated to receive reparations payments. This includes any person, community, or organization recognized as the official beneficiary of the payment.
Recipient type	Corporation Country or government Educational institution Individual victims and victim groups International or multilateral organization Non-governmental organization Religious institution Unspecified	The classification of the entity designated to receive reparations payments.
Recipient country or economy	<i>Unique value [Country or economy]</i>	The country or economy designated as the recipient of reparations, either directly or as the home/origin of the recipient entity. The list of countries and economies is based on the World Bank classification (see: https://data.worldbank.org/country).
Recipient country or economy (ISO)*	<i>Unique value [ISO code]</i>	The standardized three-letter ISO 3166-1 alpha-3 code representing the country or economy that received the reparations payment, as defined by the International Organization for Standardization (see: https://www.iso.org/iso-3166-country-codes.html). If no ISO code is available or applicable, "XXX" is used instead.

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Recipient region*		East Asia and Pacific Europe and Central Asia Latin America and the Caribbean Middle East and North Africa North America South Asia Sub-Saharan Africa Not applicable	The geographic region of the recipient, classified according to the World Bank's regional categories (see: https://data.worldbank.org/country).
Recipient income level*		Low income Lower middle income Upper middle income High income Not applicable	The recipient's economic status based on the World Bank's 2024 classification, assessing the financial capacity of recipients in reparations programs (see: https://data.worldbank.org/country and https://ourworldindata.org/grapher/world-bank-income-groups).
Broader context	Reparations type	Domestic International	Specifies whether the reparations program is domestic (payments made within the same country or economy) or international (payments involving cross-border transfers).
Context or reason for reparations		<i>Unique value [Text]</i>	The primary context, cause, or event that led to the establishment of the reparations program.
Main harm		Child maltreatment Colonization Cultural harm and forced assimilation Dispossession of land and forced displacement Economic harm Environmental damage Forced labor and slavery Harm to individual or public health Interstate war and conflict Intra-state conflict, state violence, and other forms of aggression Racism, discrimination, genocide, ethnic cleansing Sexual violence and sexual slavery	The main form of harm, injury, or injustice suffered by the individuals or groups that prompted the reparations. Only the most significant or central harm is coded here, even if multiple harms occurred. Categories are adapted from the Political Apologies Database (Schaafsma & Zoodma, 2021). For detailed definitions of each category, see Appendix I at the end of the codebook.

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	Secondary harm	Child maltreatment Colonization Cultural harm and forced assimilation Dispossession of land and forced displacement Economic harm Environmental damage Forced labor and slavery Harm to individual or public health Interstate war and conflict Intra-state conflict, state violence, and other forms of aggression Racism, discrimination, genocide, ethnic cleansing Sexual violence and sexual slavery	Additional or consequential harms resulting from, or intertwined with, the primary harm, but not the main focus of the reparations. Categories are adapted from the Political Apologies Database (Schaafsma & Zoodsma, 2021). For detailed definitions of each harm category, see Appendix I at the end of the codebook.
	Harm death impact	Yes No	Indicates whether the harm addressed by the reparations program resulted in loss of life. This captures the mortality impact of the violation or harm being addressed.
Timeline	Beginning of the harm (Date)	<i>Unique value [Dd-mmm-yyyy]</i>	The specific date when the harm, violation, or event that prompted the reparations program began. If the exact date is unknown, use the first day of the month; if only the year is known, use 1 January of that year.
	Beginning of the harm (Year)	<i>Unique value [Year]</i>	The year in which the harm, violation, or event that led to the reparations program began. If the exact year is unknown, use the best available approximation.
	Date of reparations agreement	<i>Unique value [Dd-mmm-yyyy]</i>	The specific date on which the reparations agreement was signed, enacted, committed, or pledged. If the exact date is unknown, indicate “Unknown.”
	Year of reparations agreement	<i>Unique value [Year]</i>	The year in which the reparations agreement was signed, enacted, committed, or pledged. If the year is unknown, use the best available approximation or indicate “Unknown.”
	Start date of reparations payment	<i>Unique value [Dd-mmm-yyyy]</i>	The specific date on which reparations payments began to be disbursed. If the exact date is unknown, use the best available approximation or enter 1 January of the year.
	Start year of reparations payment	<i>Unique value [Year]</i>	The year in which reparations payments began to be disbursed. If the exact year is unknown, use the best available approximation or indicate “Unknown.”
	End date of reparations payment	<i>Unique value [Dd-mmm-yyyy]</i>	The specific date on which reparations payments were completed or ended. If the exact date is unknown, use the best available approximation or enter 1 January of the year.

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	End year of reparations payment	<i>Unique value [Year]</i>	The year in which reparations payments were completed or ended. If the exact year is unknown, the best available approximation is used or the value “Unknown” is recorded. This value may refer to the actual conclusion of payments, the last year for which payment data are retrievable, or “2024” for cases where payments are ongoing and data are recorded as of 2024. This value may not reflect a definitive end date but rather an approximation based on data availability, used for analytical purposes.
	Duration of payments distribution	<i>Unique value [Number or unknown]</i>	The total length of time over which known reparations payments were distributed, calculated as the difference between the start and end years.
	Payments conversion year	<i>Unique value [Year]</i>	The year used as the reference for converting payments data (all “Paid” values). If payments occurred within a single year, that year is used. Otherwise, the reference year is determined on a case-by-case basis, with the rationale noted in the comments. This may correspond to the year for which cumulative payments are reported by the source (often already inflation-adjusted). If unavailable, the start year of payments is used.
	Additional notes on timeline	<i>Unique value [Text]</i>	Any supplementary information or clarifications regarding the timing of the reparations program, including nuances about the start, end, or distribution of payments, or any amendments to the reparations, that are not captured in the standard date or year fields.
Payments	Currency	<i>Unique value [ISO code]</i>	The currency in which reparations are pledged, paid, claimed, or under discussion, recorded using the official ISO currency code (ISO 4217, see: https://www.iso.org/iso-4217-currency-codes.html).
	Pledged (Total)	<i>Unique value [Number or unknown]</i>	The total amount of reparations pledged in the original currency of the payment (or as reported by the sources), whether fully disbursed or assumed; assumed pledges are noted in the comments and classified as “Implicit” in the “Pledge type” column.
	Pledged (Total USD)*	<i>Unique value [Number or unknown]</i>	The total amount of reparations pledged, converted into U.S. dollars using the historical exchange rate at the time of the reparations agreement (based on annual average exchange rates from the IMF database: https://data.imf.org/en/datasets/IMF.STA:ER).
	Pledged (Total USD 2024)*	<i>Unique value [Number or unknown]</i>	The total amount of reparations pledged, converted into U.S. dollars and adjusted for inflation to 2024 values to reflect present-day economic value, using historical U.S. Consumer Price Index annual average (all items) data from the U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics (see: https://www.bls.gov/cpi/).

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Pledge type	Explicit Implicit	Indicates whether the recorded pledge amount is explicit (as declared in the source extracts) or implicit, inferred from payments made when no formal pledge was recorded or when the disbursed amount exceeded the declared pledge. When implicit, the year of the agreement was not used for conversion. For further clarification, see the source extracts and comments.
Paid (Total)	<i>Unique value [Number or unknown]</i>	The total amount of reparations disbursed in the original currency of payment, based on the information available from the sources. If the original currency is not specified, the currency reported in the source is used.
Paid (Total USD)*	<i>Unique value [Number or unknown]</i>	The total amount of reparations disbursed, converted into U.S. dollars using the historical exchange rate for the indicated payments conversion year (based on annual average exchange rates from the IMF database: https://data.imf.org/en/datasets/IMF.STA:ER).
Paid (Total USD 2024)*	<i>Unique value [Number or unknown]</i>	The total amount of reparations disbursed, converted into U.S. dollars and adjusted for inflation to 2024 values to reflect present-day economic value, using historical U.S. Consumer Price Index annual average (all items) data from the U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics (see: https://www.bls.gov/cpi/).
Type of payment	Individual Collective Individual and collective	Indicates whether the reparations payment was made to individual recipients, to a collective entity (e.g., community, organization, or state) or to both.
Type of beneficiaries	Direct victims Families of the victims Direct victims and families of the victims Other	Indicates who is eligible to receive reparations and their relationship to the affected parties (e.g., victims, family members, or other designated recipients).
Estimated number of beneficiaries	<i>Unique value [Number or unknown]</i>	The reported or estimated number of individuals designated as beneficiaries of the reparations program.
Reported number of beneficiaries paid	<i>Unique value [Number or unknown]</i>	The number of individuals who actually received reparations payments, as reported by the sources.
Other data	Agreement mechanism	<i>Unique value [Text]</i> The formal legal, political, or administrative process establishing the reparations payments.
	Disbursement mechanism	<i>Unique value [Text]</i> Specifies how reparations payments are disbursed to eligible recipients, including direct payments, funds, or other mechanisms.
	Intermediary	<i>Unique value [Text]</i> Specifies whether an intermediary organization was involved in administering, facilitating, or ordering the reparations process.

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Source tracking data	Existing database(s)	<i>Unique value [Text]</i>	Identifies whether the case was sourced from an existing database and, if so, specifies the database(s) name and entry ID.
	Primary source(s)	<i>Unique value [Text]</i>	Original documents or data directly related to the reparations case (e.g., treaties, agreements, official or archival records), typically issued by the responsible or paying actor, including official public statements.
	Secondary source(s)	<i>Unique value [Text]</i>	Sources offering analyses or interpretations of primary sources, such as academic articles, reports, books, news, or online content.
	Source URL(s)	<i>Unique value [URLs]</i>	The direct URL(s) linking to the primary and secondary sources used to collect data.
	Archived URL(s) via Wayback Machine*	<i>Unique value [URLs]</i>	The URL of the source(s) archived via the Wayback Machine (https://web.archive.org) or similar services to ensure accessibility if the original link expires. When archiving via the Wayback Machine was not possible, snapshots were archived by the REPAIR team and can be downloaded from the REPAIR website.
Notes	Source extracts	<i>Unique value [Text]</i>	Direct quotes or key passages from the primary and/or secondary sources that justify or clarify the information recorded in the entry.
	Additional comments	<i>Unique value</i>	Any additional relevant details about the reparations case not captured by other variables, including notes on data recording, collection, or calculation, possible updates to the entry after 2024, and links to further readings.
	Keywords*	<i>Unique value</i>	Important keywords associated with the case for search, indexing, and categorization purposes.

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Appendix I

<i>Type of harm</i>	<i>Definition</i>
Child maltreatment	Child maltreatment refers to any form of abuse or neglect harming or threatening the health, development, or well-being of a child (under 18). This includes physical, emotional, or sexual abuse, neglect, exploitation, or other acts that cause actual or potential harm within a context of responsibility, trust, or power (see World Health Organization, 2024, https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/child-maltreatment).
Colonization	Colonization refers to the process by which one group or state establishes control over another territory and its people, imposing political, economic, and cultural dominance, exploiting resources, and displacing or subjugating indigenous populations. In the RPD, it is coded as the primary harm when explicitly identified as the overarching harm addressed in an agreement. (cf. Wikipedia, https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Colonialism).
Cultural harm and forced assimilation	Cultural harm and forced assimilation refers to actions that intentionally damage, suppress, or replace a group's cultural identity, traditions, or language. This includes bans on cultural practices and the destruction or appropriation of cultural heritage (cf. Wikipedia https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Forced_assimilation).
Dispossession of land and forced displacement	Dispossession of land and forced displacement refers to the unlawful or coerced removal of individuals or communities from their land, homes, or property, including land seizure, forced relocation, or other forms of displacement (cf. UNHCR "Handbook for the Protection of Internally Displaced Persons").
Economic harm	Economic harm refers to actions or policies that cause loss of income, assets, or livelihood, including destruction of property, expropriation, or denial of access to economic opportunities (cf. OHCHR, n.d., https://www.ohchr.org/en/human-rights/economic-social-cultural-rights).
Environmental damage	Environmental damage refers to harm caused by human activity to natural resources, including protected species, habitats, water, air, and soil, resulting in degradation, pollution, or destruction that may affect ecosystems, communities, or livelihoods (cf. European Commission https://environment.ec.europa.eu/law-and-governance/environmental-compliance-assurance/environmental-liability_en ; <i>ACT Environmental Law Handbook</i> 2015, Chapter 10 "Stopping environmental harm").
Forced labor and slavery	Forced labor and slavery refer to the coercion of individuals to perform work or services under threat, without voluntary consent. This includes slavery, where individuals are treated as property, and related practices such as bonded labor, servitude, and other conditions akin to slavery (see International Labour Organization, n.d., https://www.ilo.org/topics/forced-labour-modern-slavery-and-trafficking-persons/what-forced-labour).
Harm to individual or public health	Harm to individual or public health refers to actions, policies, or conditions that threaten or damage physical or mental health. This includes medical neglect, unethical medical experimentation, denial of healthcare, and exposure to hazardous or unsafe environments (cf. World Health Organization, n.d., https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/human-rights-and-health).
Interstate war and conflict	Interstate war and conflict refers to harms resulting from armed attacks, invasions, or military confrontations between sovereign states, whether reciprocal or one-sided. This includes large-scale casualties, destruction, displacement, and postwar reparations, indemnities, or compensation established through peace treaties or armistice agreements.
Intra-state conflict, state violence, and other forms of aggression	Intra-state conflict, state violence, and other forms of aggression refer to violent acts and systematic abuses occurring within a state, including civil wars, political repression, or state-led oppression and terrorism. Harms include torture, enforced disappearances, arbitrary or wrongful arrests, extrajudicial or mass killings, bombings, and massacres, carried out by state actors or organized non-state groups within the same state.
Racism, discrimination, genocide, ethnic cleansing	Racism, discrimination, genocide, and ethnic cleansing refer to harms targeting individuals or groups based on perceived racial, ethnic, or related identities. This includes systemic or institutionalized discrimination and exclusion (racism and discrimination), as well as extreme forms of collective violence aimed at the destruction, removal, or forced displacement of a group (genocide and ethnic cleansing) (cf. European Commission, n.d. https://ec.europa.eu/assets/home/emn-glossary/glossary.html?detail=racial+discrimination ; ECCHR, n.d. https://www.ecchr.eu/en/glossary/genocide/).
Sexual violence and sexual slavery	Sexual violence, including sexual slavery, refers to any non-consensual act of a sexual nature, including where consent cannot be given. It involves the exercise of power and control and may occur with or without physical contact. This category includes rape, sexual assault, sexual exploitation, sexual slavery, coerced sexual acts, forced pregnancy, forced sterilization, forced abortion, enforced prostitution, genital mutilation, and forced nudity, including when committed during conflict or under state authority (see ECCHR, n.d., https://www.ecchr.eu/en/glossary/sexual-violence/).